

07/08/2026

AURALITE ANNIE OF THE ARCTIC



Sleep paralysis made me lucid, and I arrived alone in the arctic.



A city of igloos glowed beneath the aurora like a warm family in the snow.



The people bartered with auralite crystals and treated them like real magic.



They played seal-skin drums, laughed together, and welcomed each other as one big family.



I enjoyed learning how their beautiful city survived in such a frozen world.



The miners searched nearby cave systems for auralite, but the work was dangerous.



Deep below the caves, geothermal heat kept rare dinosaurs alive.



Their armor looked like auralite crystals, so prey wandered close before seeing the truth.



The miners knew the danger and usually avoided disturbing the dinosaurs.



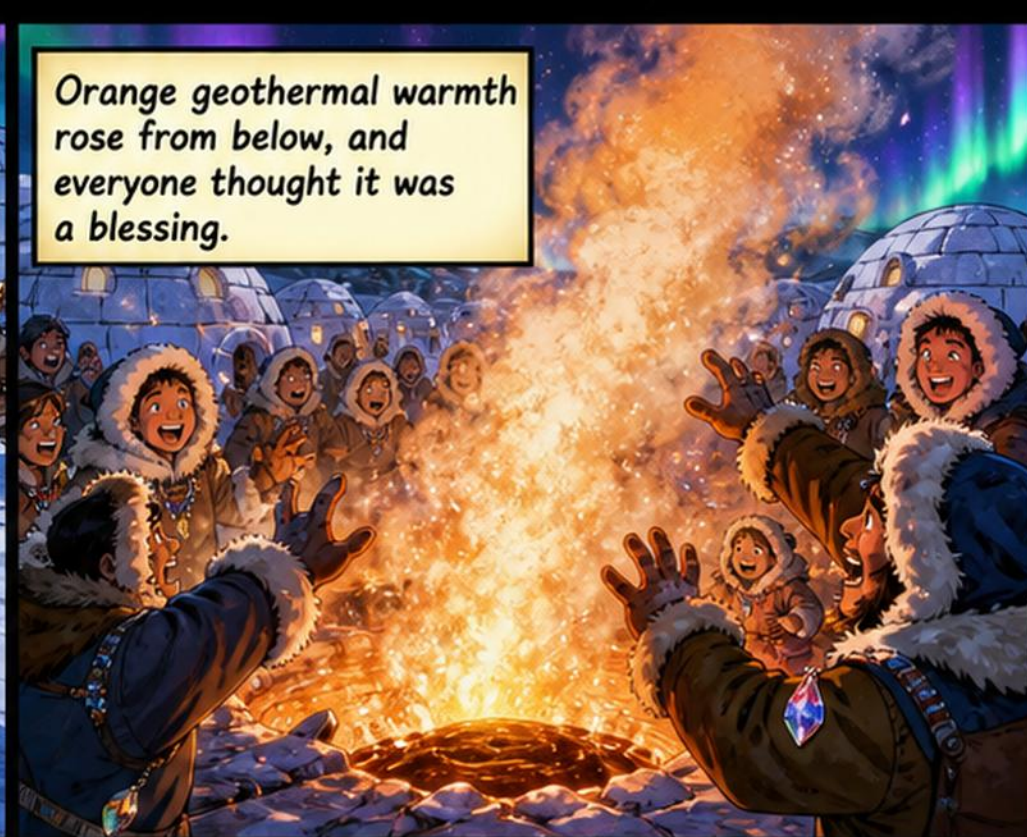
As long as the heat stayed underground, the city above remained safe.



Then a sinkhole
opened in the middle
of the city.



Orange geothermal warmth
rose from below, and
everyone thought it was
a blessing.



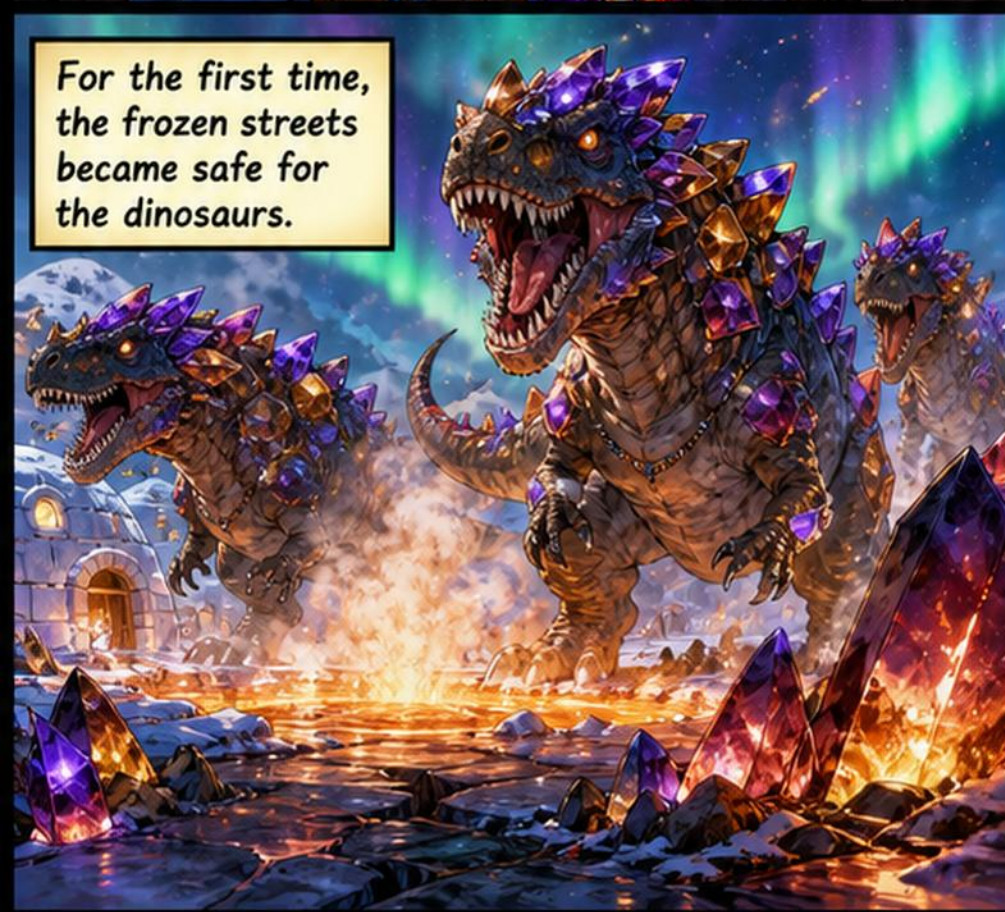
The people gathered
around it like a
communal fire.



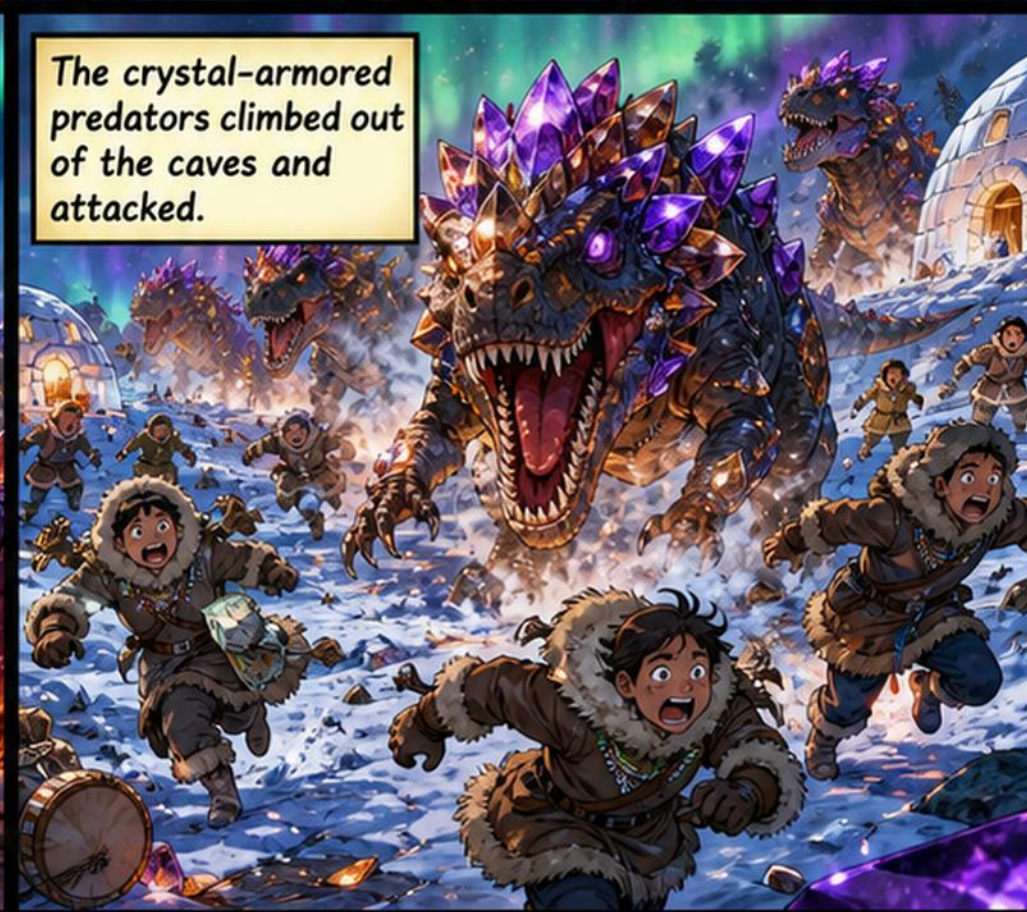
But the new warmth
changed what the
city was.



For the first time,
the frozen streets
became safe for
the dinosaurs.



The crystal-armored
predators climbed out
of the caves and
attacked.



I knew the city
needed a hero who
could protect people
from the attack.



I raised my Lucid Light
and shaped it into a
wandering explorer
named Insulation Annie.



Annie understood
the danger as soon
as she opened
her eyes.



Her power let
her expand her
back into a huge
shield of insulation
putty.



A shield could
block one attack,
but the sinkhole
was the real
problem.



Annie realized the dinosaurs would keep returning while the geothermal heat reached the city.



She chose the only protection large enough to save everyone.



She lay across the sinkhole and pressed her back into the opening.



Her insulation foam expanded until it sealed the vent completely.



The choice saved the city, but it trapped Annie on the ground forever.



Without the sinkhole warmth, the dinosaurs returned to their geothermal caves.



The people thanked Annie for saving every igloo and every family.



They brought her food and offerings so she could keep living.



Over time, they treated her like a godlike hero who guarded the city.



Even love could not change that Annie was stuck in one place for the rest of her life.



Generations later,
Annie's body withered
away, but the
insulation plug
remained.



The people forgot
the explorer who
had given them
peace.



Her protection
lasted forever,
even after her name
faded from memory.



I was proud of
the hero I created,
but next time I
may give my hero
a happier ending.

